

Day 75 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Polity (4): The 131st Constitutional Amendment Bill's Rejection

READING MATERIAL

Updates the already-covered 131st Constitutional Amendment Bill with its actual outcome — a rare real example of a constitutional amendment bill being rejected, not just passed routinely.

Q: What did the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 propose, and when was it introduced?

A: Introduced in the Lok Sabha on 16 April 2026. It proposed: increasing the Lok Sabha's maximum seats from 550 to 850 (815 from states, 35 from union territories); enabling delimitation based on the 2011 Census (rather than waiting for 2027 Census results); authorizing Parliament to decide the timing/census basis for future delimitations; and removing the requirement that women's reservation in the Lok Sabha be tied to the first census after the 2023 Women's Reservation Amendment.

Q: What happened to the Bill, and when?

A: It was NEGATIVED (rejected) in the Lok Sabha on 17 April 2026 — meaning it failed to secure the special majority required under Article 368 to amend the Constitution.

Q: What happened to the Bill's 2 companion bills as a result?

A: The Delimitation Bill, 2026 and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 — both introduced alongside the 131st Amendment Bill — could not proceed, since their statutory/constitutional foundation depended on the 131st Amendment Bill passing first.

Q: Why is this rejection notable from a constitutional-procedure standpoint?

A: It is a concrete, rare real-world demonstration that a Constitutional Amendment Bill under Article 368 requires a special majority (2/3 of members present and voting, in each House) and is NOT automatically passed just because the government introduces it — useful for correcting the common assumption that amendments routinely sail through.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 was introduced in the Lok Sabha on:

A. 16 April 2026 ✓

B. 17 April 2026

C. 18 April 2026

D. 1 April 2026

Explanation: 16 April 2026. [hard, web-research]

2. What ultimately happened to the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026?

A. It was passed unanimously

B. It was negatived (rejected) in the Lok Sabha ✓

C. It was sent to a Select Committee

D. It was withdrawn by the government before voting

Explanation: It was negatived (rejected) in the Lok Sabha on 17 April 2026. [medium, web-research]

3. The 131st Amendment Bill proposed increasing the Lok Sabha's maximum seats from 550 to:

A. 700

B. 800

C. 850 ✓

D. 900

Explanation: 850 (815 from states, 35 from union territories). [hard, web-research]

4. Which 2 companion bills could not proceed after the 131st Amendment Bill's rejection?

A. The GST Amendment Bill and the Finance Bill

B. The Delimitation Bill, 2026 and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 ✓

C. The Citizenship Amendment Bill and the National Register Bill

D. The Lokpal Bill and the Whistleblower Protection Bill

Explanation: The Delimitation Bill, 2026 and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026. [hard, web-research]

5. A Constitutional Amendment Bill under Article 368 requires what kind of majority to pass in each House?

A. Simple majority

B. A special majority (2/3 of members present and voting) ✓

C. Majority of total membership only

D. Unanimous consent

Explanation: A special majority (2/3 of members present and voting). [medium, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Logical Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Logical Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills (Part B Unit II, 10 questions total for the whole unit). Real exam evidence shows TNPSC's 'logical reasoning' label covers a wide variety of puzzle types, not just classic syllogisms — expect position-counting, ranking-from-clues, and direction-sense questions under this same heading too.

Q: Method — syllogism (statements → which conclusions necessarily follow): Statements: 'Some pens are books. All books are rods.' Conclusions: I. All pens are rods. II. Some pens are rods. III. Some books are pens. IV. All rods are pens. Which conclusions follow?

A: Only II and III follow. 'Some pens are books' + 'All books are rods' guarantees that AT LEAST SOME pens are rods (II) and that some books are indeed pens (III, since 'some pens are books' can be reversed to 'some books are pens'). It does NOT guarantee ALL pens are rods (I — only the 'some' pens that are books are guaranteed to be rods) or that ALL rods are pens (IV — nothing says rods can't include non-pen things).

Q: Method — position-in-a-line counting: Richard is 15th from the front in a column of boys. There are three times as many boys behind him as in front. How many boys are between Richard and the 7th boy from the end?

A: In front of Richard: 14 boys. Behind him: $3 \times 14 = 42$ boys. Total boys = $14 + 1 + 42 = 57$. The 7th from the end is at position $57 - 7 + 1 = 51$ from the front. Richard is at position 15. Boys between them = $51 - 15 - 1 = 35$.

Q: Method — algebraic word problem framed as a 'logical' puzzle: 106 trees were planted; non-fruit-bearing trees were 2 more than thrice the fruit-bearing trees. How many fruit-bearing trees were planted?

A: Let fruit-bearing = x . Non-fruit-bearing = $3x + 2$. Total: $x + 3x + 2 = 106 \rightarrow 4x = 104 \rightarrow x = 26$.

Q: Method — ranking from multiple comparative clues: Given several statements comparing four people's scores (e.g., 'Rama scored more than Rani but less than Rathna...'), determine who scored highest.

A: Work through each comparative clue methodically, building a single ordered chain (e.g., Rathna > Rama > Ramya > Rani), rather than trying to hold all comparisons in your head at once — write the partial order down step by step as each clue is read.

Q: Method — meaningful word sequencing: Arrange in a logical sequence: Honey, Flower, Bee, Wax.

A: Flower → Bee → Honey → Wax. The logic: a bee visits a Flower, produces Honey, and the Honey-making process also yields Wax (beeswax) — order reflects the natural/causal sequence of the process, not alphabetical or arbitrary order.

Q: Method — direction sense: A person starts walking, turns left, then turns left again, and is now heading East. Which direction did they originally start in?

A: West. Two consecutive left turns reverse the original direction (left+left = 180° turn), so if they end up heading East, they must have started heading West.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Statements: 'Some doctors are teachers. All teachers are readers.' Conclusions: I. Some doctors are readers. II. All doctors are readers. III. Some readers are teachers. Which follow?

A. Only I and III ✓

B. Only II

C. All three

D. None

Explanation: I and III follow the same logic as the worked example (some doctors are guaranteed readers via the teacher link; some readers are guaranteed teachers by reversing 'some'). II overreaches — not ALL doctors are teachers, so not all are guaranteed readers. [hard, authored]

2. In a column of boys, Meena is 10th from the front, and there are twice as many boys behind her as in front. How many boys are in the column in total?

A. 27

B. 28 ✓

C. 29

D. 30

Explanation: In front: 9. Behind: $2 \times 9 = 18$. Total = $9 + 1 + 18 = 28$. [medium, authored]

3. A farmer planted 84 saplings in total. The number of flowering saplings was 3 more than twice the number of non-flowering saplings. How many non-flowering saplings were planted?

A. 25

B. 27 ✓

C. 29

D. 31

Explanation: Let non-flowering= x . Flowering= $2x+3$. Total: $x+2x+3=84 \rightarrow 3x=81 \rightarrow x=27$. [medium, authored]

4. Arrange in a logical sequence: Seed, Tree, Fruit, Sapling.

A. Seed-Sapling-Tree-Fruit ✓

B. Seed-Tree-Sapling-Fruit

C. Sapling-Seed-Tree-Fruit

D. Seed-Fruit-Sapling-Tree

Explanation: A Seed grows into a Sapling, which matures into a Tree, which eventually bears Fruit. [easy, authored]

5. A person walks north, turns right, walks on, then turns right again. Which direction are they now facing?

A. North

B. South ✓

C. East

D. West

Explanation: Two consecutive right turns reverse the original direction: North $\rightarrow$ (right) East $\rightarrow$ (right) South. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Grammar: Active and Passive Voice

READING MATERIAL

Tests converting sentences between active and passive voice across different tenses, plus recognising when a sentence already IS passive/active.

Q: Change to passive voice: "They write letters."

A: Letters are written by them. (Simple present: object 'letters' becomes subject; verb becomes 'are written'.)

Q: "The book was written by Shakespeare." Is this sentence in active or passive voice?

A: Passive voice (subject 'the book' receives the action; the doer 'Shakespeare' is introduced with 'by').

Q: Change to passive voice: "She is cooking dinner."

A: Dinner is being cooked by her. (Present continuous passive: 'is being' + past participle.)

Q: Passive of "They will help you"?

A: You will be helped by them. (Simple future passive: 'will be' + past participle.)

Q: Change to passive voice: "Who wrote this poem?"

A: By whom was this poem written? (WH-questions about the doer move 'by whom' to the front, and invert subject-verb like other passive questions.)

Q: Real exam: "The Manager will give you a ticket." Which passive forms correctly convey this? (a) A ticket will be given to the Manager by you (b) A ticket will be given to you by the Manager (c) The Manager will be given a ticket by you (d) You will be given a ticket by the Manager

A: (b) AND (d) are both correct — a sentence with 2 objects (indirect object 'you', direct object 'a ticket') can be passivized by promoting EITHER object to subject. (a) and (c) wrongly reverse who is the giver vs. receiver.

Q: Real exam: "The wounded man was being helped by some boys." What is the correct ACTIVE form?

A: Some boys were helping the wounded man. (Past continuous: 'was being helped' → 'were helping', with the doer 'some boys' becoming the subject.)

Q: Real exam: "We know that some children go wise early." Which passive forms are correct? 1. It is known that some children go wise early. 2. Some children are known to go wise early. 3. It is being known that some children go wise early. 4. Some children are being known to go wise early.

A: 1 AND 2 are both correct — this is an 'impersonal passive' pattern with a that-clause, which can be passivized either by keeping 'It is known that...' or by restructuring to '[Subject] are known to...'. Options 3 and 4 wrongly use continuous passive ('is being known'), which doesn't fit this general-truth statement.

Q: Real exam: "She had already sent the parcel." What is the correct passive form?

A: The parcel had already been sent by her. (Past perfect passive — must preserve 'had...been', not shift to present perfect 'has been sent'.)

Q: Real exam: "The rules should not be violated." What is the correct ACTIVE voice form?

A: Nobody should violate the rules. (A passive sentence with an implied negative/no-one doer converts to active using 'Nobody' as the subject, not 'You should not' or 'Anybody should not'.)

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Change to passive voice: "They write letters."

A. Letters are written by them. ✓

B. Letters were written by them.

C. Letters had been written.

D. They have written letters.

Explanation: Letters are written by them. [easy, web-research]

2. "The book was written by Shakespeare." This sentence is in:

A. Active voice

B. Passive voice ✓

C. Perfect tense (voice not applicable)

D. Continuous tense (voice not applicable)

Explanation: Passive voice. [easy, web-research]

3. Change to passive voice: "She is cooking dinner."

A. Dinner is cooked by her.

B. Dinner is being cooked by her. ✓

C. Dinner has been cooked.

D. Dinner will be cooked.

Explanation: Dinner is being cooked by her. [medium, web-research]

4. Passive of "They will help you":

A. You are helped by them.

B. You were helped.

C. You will be helped by them. ✓

D. You will help them.

Explanation: You will be helped by them. [medium, web-research]

5. Change to passive voice: "Who wrote this poem?"

A. By whom was this poem written? ✓

B. This poem was written by who?

C. This poem was being written.

D. This poem is written by whom?

Explanation: By whom was this poem written? [medium, web-research]

6. "The Manager will give you a ticket." Which passive forms are correct? (a) A ticket will be given to the Manager by you (b) A ticket will be given to you by the Manager (c) The Manager will be given a ticket by you (d) You will be given a ticket by the Manager

A. (a) and (b)

B. (b) and (d) ✓

C. (b) and (c)

D. (a) and (d)

Explanation: (b) and (d) — both correctly preserve who gives and who receives. [hard, question-bank-2025]

7. "The wounded man was being helped by some boys." Select the correct ACTIVE form.

A. Some boys helped the wounded man.

B. Some boys have helped the wounded man.

C. Some boys were helping the wounded man. ✓

D. Some boys are helping the wounded man.

Explanation: Some boys were helping the wounded man. [medium, question-bank-2025]

8. "We know that some children go wise early." Select the correct passive voice. 1. It is known that some children go wise early 2. Some children are known to go wise early 3. It is being known that some children go wise early 4. Some children are being known to go wise early

A. 1 only

B. 2 only

C. 1 and 2 ✓

D. 3 and 4

Explanation: 1 and 2. [hard, question-bank-2025]

9. "She had already sent the parcel." Select the correct passive form.

A. The parcel has already been sent by her.

B. The parcel had already been sent by her. ✓

C. The parcel was already sent by her.

D. The parcel was already sent to her.

Explanation: The parcel had already been sent by her. [medium, question-bank-2024]

10. "The rules should not be violated." Choose the correct Active Voice.

A. You should violate the rules.

B. Anybody should not violate the rules.

C. Do not violate the rules.

D. Nobody should violate the rules. ✓

Explanation: Nobody should violate the rules. [medium, question-bank-2024]